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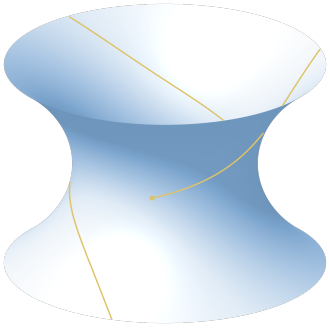
Federal Fraud Expansion
Working Document

Partner agencies

Landscape and prioritization

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When: 11:28am UTC on October 27th, 2026



$$\mathcal{G}(x) = x^x \qquad \nabla_{\dot\gamma}\dot\gamma = 0$$

We navigate our clients from a challenging problem to a defensible solution along the shortest rigorous path.

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As of: 2026-10-25. Public data only. Scores are our judgment from the sources listed at the end; they are a starting point for discussion, not a measured result.

Update 2026-10-27: the same method now covers the 33 largest agencies by FY2026 outlays in top33.pdf. Ranks in the individual briefs are now out of 33.

1 Bottom line

Start with **HHS (Medicare and Medicaid providers)**, then **DoD contracting** and **USDA nutrition programs**. Keep **SBA** running as the baseline that proves the method. HHS has the most money at risk (about $90B in FY2025 improper payments across Medicare and Medicaid) and the richest public provider-level data, and its hospice and home health fraud is the stated priority of the new whistleblower program. DoD contracting is the closest match to the SBA work: the same SAM.gov, FPDS and set-aside data, applied to the largest contract budget in government. USDA's SNAP retailer and child meal programs bring the day care and food fraud patterns the program also names.

2 Which agencies are in scope

america.gov/fraud is the intake form for DOJ's Whistleblower Incentive Program (WHIP), launched 2026-10-20 with $25M from Treasury and awards of $10K to $30K when charges are filed. DOJ's terms page says tips must concern federal health care offenses or fraud on programs run by these **eight agencies**:

Agency	Example program named by DOJ	Brief
Health and Human Services (incl. CMS)	Health care benefit programs	hhs.pdf
War (Defense)	—	dod.pdf
Small Business Administration	—	sba.pdf
Agriculture	SNAP	usda.pdf
Veterans Affairs	—	va.pdf
Housing and Urban Development	—	hud.pdf
Education	Student aid fraud	ed.pdf
Labor	Unemployment fraud	dol.pdf

DOJ (which pays the awards) and Treasury (which funds them) run the program rather than being program agencies, so they are partners for referrals, not targets. The site itself blocks automated reading, so this list comes from DOJ's terms page, which the site links to. It should still be checked against the live site. The wider task force and DOJ's National Fraud Detection Center also name Treasury (EITC), SSA, DHS, Interior and OMB; see "Wave 2" below.

3 How we scored

Each agency gets 1 to 5 on four factors, weighted toward what we can do with public data alone.



Factor	Weight	What 5 means
Exposure	30%	Tens of billions a year in improper payments or fraud-prone spend
Public data	30%	Record-level data that names payees (providers, contractors, retailers)
SBA method fit	20%	The SBA patterns (shell entities, shared identifiers, stacked awards, ineligible recipients) apply directly
Actionability	20%	A WHIP priority area, active enforcement, and a clear owner to take findings to

4 Ranking

Rank	Agency	Exposure	Public data	SBA fit	Action	Score	First prototype
1	HHS (CMS)	5	5	4	5	**4.8**	Hospice and home health provider risk map
2	DoD	4	5	5	3	**4.3**	Small business set-aside contractor integrity screen
—	SBA (baseline)	3	5	5	4	**4.2**	Extend current work to 7(a), 504 and 8(a)
3	USDA	4	3	4	5	**3.9**	SNAP retailer and child meal sponsor anomalies
4	VA	3	4	4	3	**3.5**	SDVOSB contract and GI Bill school screen
5	HUD	3	3	3	3	**3.0**	Multifamily owner network and disaster grant screen
6	Education	2	3	3	3	**2.7**	Ghost student risk by college
7	Labor	3	1	2	4	**2.4**	State UI anomaly dashboard from aggregates

Score = 0.3 × Exposure + 0.3 × Public data + 0.2 × SBA fit + 0.2 × Action.

5 Recommended sequence

1. **Now: HHS and DoD.** HHS gives the biggest dollar story; DoD gives the fastest technical win because it reuses the SBA contractor pipeline as is.
2. **Next: USDA and VA.** USDA adds retailer and sponsor fraud; VA shares the contractor pipeline with DoD and adds veteran-owned set-asides.
3. **Later: HUD, Education, Labor.** Their public data is aggregate or thin. They are better approached once an agency pilot grants non-public data.

6 Shared building blocks

Every brief reuses the same core, which is what makes a government-wide program realistic:

- **Entity spine:** SAM.gov entity records (UEI, address, owners, exclusions) joined to USAspending awards and FPDS contracts.
- **Exclusion and enforcement lists:** SAM.gov exclusions, HHS-OIG LEIE, DOJ press releases and OIG reports, used both as labels to train on and as watch lists.
- **Common patterns:** many payees at one address, new entities winning large awards fast, shared officers across "competing" firms, payees tied to excluded parties, and spending far above peers.



7 Wave 2 candidates (outside the eight)

Agency	Why it matters	Public data
Treasury / IRS	EITC improper payments $21.1B (32.7%) in FY2025	Aggregate only; preparer-level data not public
SSA	SSI improper payments $7.3B (11.6%) in FY2025	Aggregate only
DHS / FEMA	Disaster assistance fraud	OpenFEMA has program-level and some recipient data

All three now have full briefs: treasury.pdf, ssa.pdf and dhs.pdf; see top33.pdf.

8 Sources

- DOJ Whistleblower Rewards Program terms (lists the eight agencies)
- Latin Times: inside DOJ's WHIP program (launch date, award range, $25M)
- Runtime Wire: America.gov AI-assisted tip form
- GAO-26-108694: improper payments rose to $186B in FY2025
- CRFB: FY2025 improper payments by program
- GAO-24-105833: federal fraud losses estimated at $233B to $521B a year
- Working plan for this project